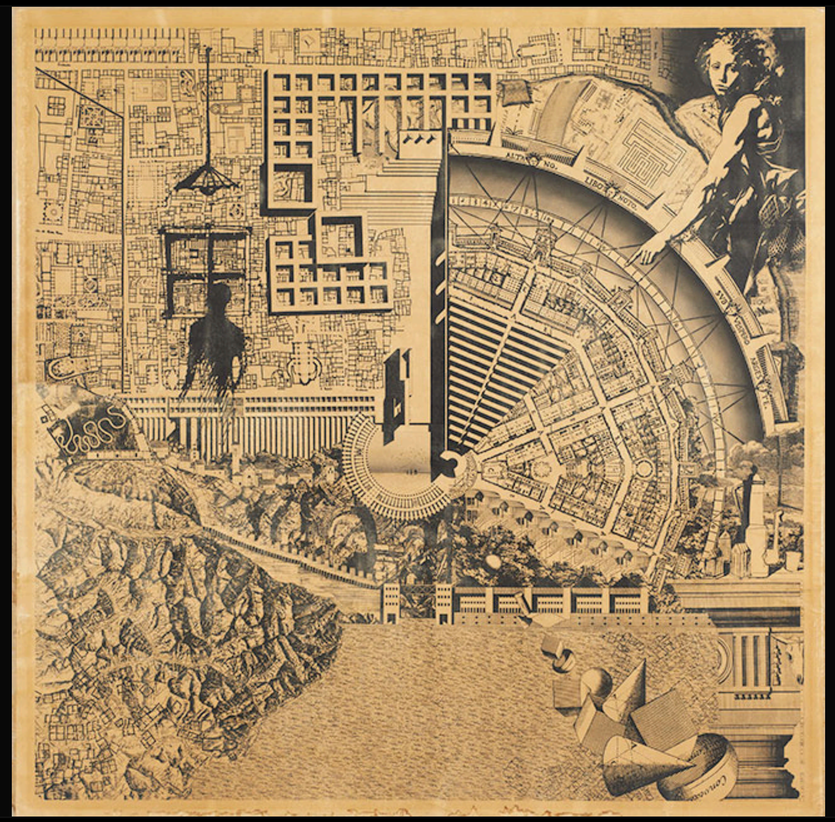

Architecture contains memory. Spaces contain memories, old walls are torn down, types of architectural witness marks are left, with tooling marks and bits of material leftovers. Many of these are hidden below the surface, covered by fresh gypsum and spackle, left to only be discovered by the next entity that tears down these walls; finding hidden messages from years ago only to cover them up again with what they've deemed to be the appropriate material, orientation, color, accessory placement or other interventions performed on spaces within their lifespan. We see examples of this even in a city as young as Los Angeles. The easiest example to point to would be the entirety of the SCI-Arc building. Its layers of addition and subtraction repeated countless times has left it with layers of stories. A saturated memory of the palimpsest of information embedded within its walls. Other examples of these layers of operations can be found all over the city of Los Angeles. The 110 freeway exhibits stairways to nowhere, the odd remnants of the Belmont (Pacific Electric) Tunnel that once housed the Hollywood Subway.The Bradbury Building reveals its temporal layering through cracked marble floors, patched materials, and the uncanny presence of contemporary fire doors rudely inserted into historic interiors. These collisions of old and new produce moments of dissonance, where architectural time collapses into a single frame. Architecture's role is not merely as a container for memory, but it is also a performative actor. Architecture is not a static thing. It ebbs and flows with time, negotiating nature, destruction, and building codes. Constantly updating itself, gathering new information, morphing into its most recent version, most suitable for whatever its new contemporary context is. Vestiges of previous architectural logic still seep out into the contemporary surface, shifting understandings and contexts as they rise. It is often argued that Los Angeles' architectural ethos exists in a system of forgetting and erasure, but those pieces of the past are never erased. The materials are shifted to other locations, meant for alternative uses (even if that is just in a landfill) but the material can never be fully erased. Only its physical and temporal context has shifted. Old structures are modified and distorted. In the Art's District we find the result of its direct connection to the rail lines of the city's industrial past. Many moments of oddly shaped buildings, wrapped around train tracks with elegant curves, obtuse angles, and extremely long and narrow buildings. Misalignments and forced geometries, blocked in windows that are now structural entities of the building. Memory becomes a spatial constraint, a limitation on the interventions we may deem necessary. These remnants of the past can be seen as an inherited error of the data set. A hole in the boat that must be plugged in order to maintain stability. When a container system breaks down, the result is not absence, but of excess. This failed integrity leads not to emptiness but towards noise, ambiguity, and hallucination. Architecture is guilty of the most apophenic tendencies. Forever